

Insert Super Cool Render Here

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Introduction

Paladado (n.): 1. A really fun GBA game submitted to GBA Jam 2026. The name is derived from the words “palabra” and “dado”, or the Spanish words for “word” and “dice”, respectively.

Paladado is a rogue-lite word game where you must find valid words from a grid of 4x4 letters to meet a point requirement that increases each level. You have may submit up to four words to meet this point requirement.

After you meet the point requirement for the level, you may purchase dice, fonts and letters and replace those in your set to increase the number of points per word you score and increase your chances of finding longer, higher scoring words.

If you score enough points to meet the increasing requirements for 15 levels, you beat the demo! Otherwise, if you don't meet the point requirement for a level, you lose the game.

Controls

On the board:

L: Clear Entire
Word

R: Submit
Word

A: Select Letters

B: Backspace

D-Pad: Move Cursor

Select: Display
Guide



In the shop:



In the shop (cont.)



D-Pad: Move
Cursor/
Rotate
Selected Die

Select: Display
Guide

A: View each face
/ Apply Item to
Die/Face

Gameplay

You start a round with your dice randomly ordered and rolled on the board:



Gameplay (cont.)

Select up to four words for submission. Two have been highlighted for your convenience:

S	K	H	M
R	D	S	N
I	E	B	V
D	U	G	F

PREV.
WORDS
RIDE
DUG

CURR.
WORD

POINTS
2 / 2
MONEY
6
A=PICK

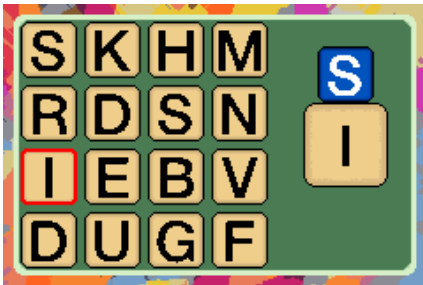
Gameplay (cont.)

Once you have met the point requirement for the round, you will see this screen. Press any button to exit to go to the shop.



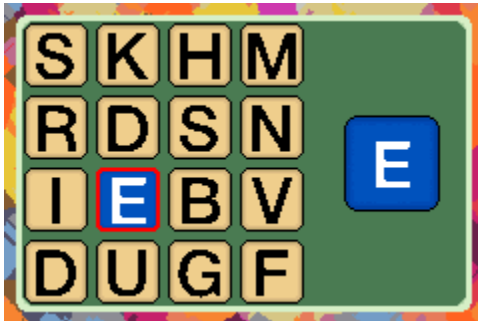
Gameplay (cont.)

Here in the shop, you can purchase dice, letters or fonts to swap out ones in your set. Press A on an item if you wish to purchase it. If you do, it will take you to your current dice.



Gameplay (cont.)

There, you can apply your item to a die by pressing A.



Gameplay (cont.)

You may view your current dice without needing to purchase an item by pressing right on the D-Pad until you see the dice.

You may leave the shop and continue to the next level by pressing B on the shop screen.

In-Game Guides:

Forget what a certain die or letter does? Just press the Select button while on the board, shop or current dice screens. This brings up a guide screen that reminds you what that die's features are.

Ending the Game:

You play until you either win (beat 15 levels) or lose (fail to meet the point requirement for a level).

Valid Word Requirements

For a word to be valid, it must meet the following criteria:

- Words must be three to eight letters in length.
- The word must not be a previously submitted word
 - Words within words are allowed, such as "mast" and "aster" within "master".
- Each letter after the first must be a horizontal, vertical, or diagonal neighbor of the one before it.
 - There are exceptions to this rule, see the ***Letter Effects*** section of this booklet
- No individual letter cube may be used more than once in a word.
- No capitalized or hyphenated words are allowed.

Scoring Formula

Scored Points
=
Base Score for Word Length
+
Additional Bonus Points
x
Score Multiplier

- When calculating your score for a word, the additional bonus points are added to the base score before the score multiplier is applied.

Point Requirement by Level

Level	Points Required to Pass	Level	Points Required to Pass
1	2	11	32
2	3	12	38
3	4	13	44
4	6	14	51
5	8	15	58
6	11		
7	14		
8	18		
9	22		
10	27		

Dice Effects:



No Color: No effect

Black: When a word includes the black dice, all adjacent cubes not used in the word are temporarily replaced with wildcard letters. You can only include one of these wildcards per word and the wildcard must follow the letter on the black dice.

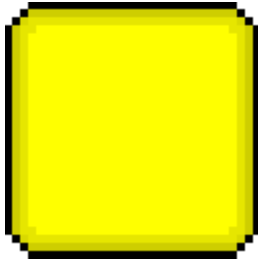
Dice Effects (cont.)



Brown: Including the brown dice in a word rerolls all adjacent dice to the brown dice on the board after scoring.

Red: When a word includes the red dice, the word gains +3 additional bonus points.

Dice Effects (cont.)



Orange: The orange dice grants additional bonus points equal to the number of turns in a word. The more twists and turns you have in your word, the higher the additional bonus points. *A straight line gives no points.*

Yellow: Including the yellow dice in a word add a x2 score multiplier to the next word found. This multiplier stacks with other multipliers.

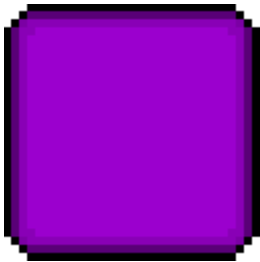
Dice Effects (cont.)



Green: You gain extra money equal to the point value of the word if a green die is included in the word (maximum of 11).

Blue: When a word includes the blue dice, the word is treated as if it is one letter longer for scoring purposes.

Dice Effects (cont.)



Purple: The purple die adds a +5 score multiplier if the word includes at least two other colored dice in the word.

Gray: Including the gray die means you may skip an adjacent letter (effectively removing the next letter from the submitted word). The excluded die effects are still included in scoring.

Dice Effects (cont.)



White: Each die included after the white die adds cumulative bonus points. For example, if there are 3 dice after the white die, the bonus points are $3+2+1 = 6$